



We Can Cook

By Anna Kirschberg



Book Summary

This non-fiction book title looks at cooking, restaurant activities and being a chef, with vibrant, diverse and modern photography. In the book, the reader is introduced to new phonics sounds.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 3 progression and focuses on learning the next 25 graphemes that are taught in this sequence.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Letters & Sounds) along with 'Heart Words' or 'Common Exception Words' (CEWs). Heart Words are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase 3 - Phonics

j	v	w	x	y	z	zz	qu	ch
sh	th	ng	ai	ee	igh	oa	oi	oo
ow	ar	air	ear	er	ur	or	ure	

Heart Words:

the, as, he, she, be, we

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and images;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Making connections between prior knowledge and the text;
- Summarising the main ideas.

This book also supports non-fiction strategies:

- Gaining information from photographs;
- Encountering curriculum related terms and concepts.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover image and make connections with the children's prior knowledge of this topic. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

What does the title of the book tell you about the front cover image?

Describe the image on the front cover.

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud any heart words from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Page 2 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. Sound out the letter sounds as you go, for example: cook = /c/oo/k/.

Page 3 – The lady in this photograph is a chef in a restaurant kitchen.

Pages 4 and 5 – In this photograph, describe what you can see in the images.

Pages 6 and 7 – Here, the reader will encounter new Phase 3 letter sounds (vowel digraphs) in words like 'loaf' and 'cool'. Sound out the letter sounds as you go, for example: loaf = /l/oa/f/.

Page 8 – Describe what the photograph on the final page is showing.

Children can now read the book independently.

At the end of the book, go over the text and photographs again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back to the table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the book that use the new graphemes being taught in Phase 3.

To start with, identify as many new vowel graphemes as you can in the words in the text.

For example, in the word 'cook', where can you find the /oo/ featured? Which words in this book feature the 'oo' sound? Is it a short or a long sound?

Look at the use of punctuation in the story. Can you find the pages with a question mark in the text?

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the introduction of different types of letter sounds (phonics) being used in the text of the story.